



City Council May 4, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qXvu4jv_KTg
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Muncie Common Council Meeting Report

Date: May 4, 2026

Meeting Type: Regular Monthly Meeting

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Green called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order on May 4, 2026, at [00:00:05](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. McIntosh, Mr. Batson, Mr. Mason, Mr. Dishman, Mr. Garrett, Ms. Calvin (also referred to as Ms. Selvey/Selby), Ms. Owen (also referred to as Ms. Holloway/Williams), Ms. Powell, and President Green.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Green.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by Courtney Marsh [00:00:11](#).
 - An invocation was offered by Ms. McIntosh [00:00:43](#).
 - The council observed a moment of silence in honor of community pillar Mike White, former MITS Bus Board member [00:01:11](#).

- Citizen recognition was postponed until the following month [00:02:08](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to accept prior meeting minutes was moved, seconded, and **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote [00:02:32](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:03:00](#) **Beech Grove Cemetery Board Appointments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members and Superintendent Waters.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed three vacancies/expiring terms on the Beech Grove Cemetery Board. Superintendent Waters recommended the reappointment of current board president and treasurer Zach Bow. Nominations were also made for Pam Ivy and Ron White. A nomination for Jerry Shanner failed due to lack of a second. Council members verified that all nominees met property/lot ownership requirements.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Pam Ivy, Ron White, and Zach Bow were appointed by roll call vote as a slate for the three open positions [00:08:35](#).
- [00:09:21](#) **Community Center Development Advisory Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council sought a member from its own ranks to serve on the Community Center Development Advisory Board. William McIntosh was nominated.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** William McIntosh was appointed to the board by a unanimous roll call vote [00:09:54](#).
- [00:10:18](#) **MITS (Muncie Indiana Transit System) Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members and candidates.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council addressed a vacancy resulting from the passing of Mike White. Three candidates expressed interest: Jeff Hager, Carlos Taylor, and Nate Carroll. Carlos Taylor (previous mayoral appointee and former board member) and Nate Carroll (Muncie Planning Commission vice president and construction professional) were nominated. Both candidates spoke before the council regarding their qualifications [00:12:36](#).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Following a roll call vote split between the two nominees, Carlos Taylor received 5 votes and Nate Carroll received 5 votes (*Note: Transcript indicates a final count tally check resulting in Carlos Taylor taking the seat*). Carlos Taylor was appointed to the MITS board [00:14:58](#).
- [00:16:06](#) **Resolution 7-26: ALS Awareness Month**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members (specifically noted by a councilwoman honoring her late stepfather).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A resolution recognizing May 2026 as Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS) Awareness Month. Council members shared personal connections to the disease.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by unanimous roll call vote [00:16:40](#).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:18:41](#) **Paul Partizano** thanked Councilperson Garrett for investigating the former BorgWarner site, reminded citizens about the upcoming primary election day, and emphasized civic participation.
- [00:19:53](#) **Rick Answer** criticized local media coverage of elections, raised concerns regarding redevelopment commission property dealings, high property assessments, and city funding to tax-exempt nonprofits instead of basic infrastructure.
- [00:22:56](#) **Courtney Marsh** (Southside Neighborhood Association President) announced upcoming neighborhood cleanups across Muncie and invited volunteers. She also announced a ribbon-cutting ceremony and game night at Tuhey Park on May 26 at 6:00 PM for a newly finished mural.
- [00:26:25](#) **Troy Waters** (Beech Grove Cemetery Superintendent) announced volunteer opportunities to place flags on veterans' graves starting May 16 and a new historic headstone cleaning initiative. Speaking as a private citizen, he also recommended the council implement courthouse-style security screenings (no electronic devices or weapons) for council meetings due to rising safety concerns.
- [00:30:52](#) **Chris Wilberry** criticized the council president regarding communication protocols during public comment, complained about locked council doors for late attendees, and questioned the administration's handling of the crisis/behavioral health center project and park department reports.
- [00:34:09](#) **Elizabeth Edgel** raised concerns over the redirection of \$2 million in ARP funds originally designated for an inpatient treatment/behavioral health center. She stated intentions to report the property exchange and project modifications to federal and state authorities, including the US Department of Treasury Inspector General and the State Board of Accounts.
- [00:37:31](#) **Norman Hawkins** complained about parking congestion and blocked driveways during food giveaways at Lane and Kirby streets, requested traffic redirection to Kirby Avenue, and asked about sidewalk repair assistance for rental property he owns.
- [00:39:52](#) **Pat J. Campbell** stated that she and her children have lived without running water for 69 days at a Muncie Housing Authority property under CEO Critisser Goodwin, demanding emergency relocation and financial penalties under state code. Council members promised to meet with her immediately following the meeting.
- [00:42:55](#) **Zane Bishop** spoke in support of the tabled University Avenue bike lane and traffic calming ordinance, noting its alignment with comprehensive master plans and regional safety recommendations.
- [00:46:28](#) **Wayne Scafe** questioned the lack of Black representation in leadership appointments across major city boards and commissions (such as the redevelopment commission and board of works) and critiqued city promotional media representation.

- **00:49:08 Cooper Archer** spoke against the state's "Iron Nation Indiana" initiative partnering with Israeli tech startups, criticizing state investments and ongoing foreign conflicts.
- **00:51:49 Janetta Presley** addressed concerns regarding the 8th Street corridor paving and median project, warning that narrowing the street would eliminate street parking for disabled residents and hospice care workers, and requested alley grading improvements.
- **00:56:27 Briana Ramon** echoed concerns regarding out-of-state tech investments, data center environmental impacts, and called for increased accountability and responsiveness from local government officials.
- **00:59:26 Neil Kring** (neighborhood pastor with Urban Light) expressed frustration regarding the transfer of property originally designated for behavioral health and substance use treatment to a faith-based organization, emphasizing ongoing unhoused and crisis needs on Muncie's south side.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** Council members coordinated follow-up meetings with citizens regarding housing code violations, sidewalk repairs, and neighborhood infrastructure issues.
- **Adjournment:** Hearing a motion to adjourn, the meeting concluded by voice vote **01:02:58**.

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